

Jacobi Field

(M, g) is a Riemannian mfd. Consider $p \in M$,

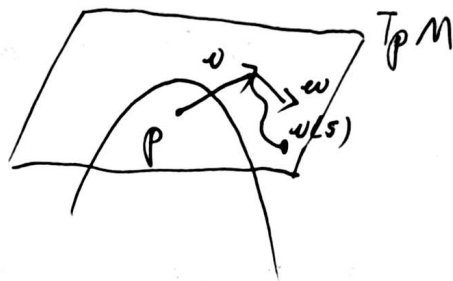
$$\exp_p: T_p M \rightarrow M, v \mapsto \text{a point}$$

f is a parametrized surface,

$$f(t, s) = \exp_p(t v(s)), \quad 0 \leq t \leq 1, \quad -\varepsilon \leq s \leq \varepsilon, \quad v(0) = v, \quad v'(0) = w.$$

$$(d\exp_p)_v w = \frac{df}{ds}(1, 0)$$

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial f}{\partial s}(t, s) &= (d\exp_p)_{tv(s)} \left(\frac{\partial}{\partial s}(tv(s)) \right) \\ &= d(\exp_p)_{tv(s)}(tv'(s)) \end{aligned}$$



So

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial s}(1, 0) = (d\exp_p)_v w$$

Consider $\underbrace{|(d\exp_p)_v(w)|}_A$, this is the rate of spreading of geodesics $t \mapsto \exp_p(t v(s))$

$$t_0: A > 0$$



①

$$A = 0$$



Then, consider

$$\begin{aligned} 0 &= \frac{D}{\partial s} \left(\frac{p}{\partial t} \frac{\partial f}{\partial t} \right) = \frac{D}{\partial t} \frac{D}{\partial s} \frac{\partial f}{\partial t} - R \left(\frac{\partial f}{\partial s}, \frac{\partial f}{\partial t} \right) \frac{\partial f}{\partial t} \\ &= \frac{D}{\partial t} \frac{D}{\partial s} \frac{\partial f}{\partial t} + R \left(\frac{\partial f}{\partial t}, \frac{\partial f}{\partial s} \right) \frac{\partial f}{\partial t} \end{aligned}$$

With $s=0$, we have $\begin{cases} \frac{\partial f}{\partial s}(t, 0) = J(t) \\ \frac{\partial f}{\partial t}(t, 0) = \gamma'(t) \end{cases}$.

$$\Rightarrow \frac{D^2}{dt^2} J + R(\gamma'(t), J(t)) \gamma'(t) = 0 \quad \underline{(*)}$$

(*) is call Jacobi equation.

Def:

Let $\gamma: [0, a] \rightarrow M$ be a geodesic in M . J is a vector field along γ . J is a Jacobi if it satisfies Jacobi equation (*) for all $t \in [0, a]$.

Let $e_1(t), \dots, e_n(t)$ be parallel, orthonormal fields along γ . Then,

$$J(t) = \sum_i f_i(t) e_i(t)$$

$$a_{ij} = \langle R(\gamma'(t), e_i(t)) \gamma'(t), e_j(t) \rangle, \quad i, j = 1, 2, \dots, n$$

$$\Rightarrow \frac{D^2 J}{dt^2} = \sum_i f_i''(t) e_i(t)$$

Since

$$R(\gamma', J) \gamma' = \sum_i \langle R(\gamma', J) \gamma', e_j \rangle e_j$$

$$= \sum_i f_i \langle R(\gamma', e_i) \gamma', e_j \rangle e_j$$

$$= \sum_{i,j} f_i a_{ij} e_j$$

(2)

Then, (*) becomes

$$f_j''(t) + \sum_i a_{ij}(t) f_i(t) = 0, \quad j = 1, 2, \dots, n$$

which is a linear system of 2nd-order.

Given $J(w)$ and $\frac{DJ}{dt}(w)$, the equation has a unique C^∞ solution on $[0, a]$. $\exists 2n$ linearly independent Jacobi fields along γ .

Example:

Let M be a Riemannian mfd of constant sectional curvature K . $\gamma: [0, L] \rightarrow M$ be a normalized geodesic on M . Let J be Jacobi field along γ , $|\gamma'| = 1$.

Consider the Jacobi field along γ , that are normal to γ' . Then,

$$\begin{aligned} \langle R(\gamma', J)\gamma', T \rangle &= K \{ \langle \gamma', \gamma' \rangle \langle J, T \rangle - \underbrace{\langle \gamma', T \rangle \langle J, \gamma' \rangle}_{=0} \} \\ &= K \langle J, T \rangle \quad (\text{where } T \text{ is any field along } \gamma) \end{aligned}$$

$$\Rightarrow \frac{D^2 J}{dt^2} + KJ = 0$$

Let $w(t)$ be a parallel field along γ with $\langle \gamma'(t), w(t) \rangle = 0$.

Let $|w(t)| = 1$.

Then, we have the 2nd-order ODE with characteristic equations

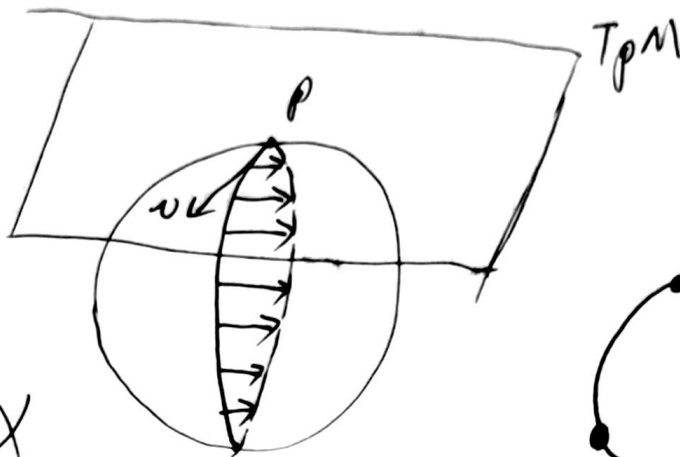
$$\begin{cases} \langle \gamma'(t), w(t) \rangle = 0 \\ |w(t)| = 1 \end{cases} \quad \text{So}$$

$$J(t) = \begin{cases} \frac{\sin(t\sqrt{K})}{\sqrt{K}} w(t) & K > 0 \\ t w(t) & K = 0 \\ \frac{\sinh(t\sqrt{-K})}{\sqrt{-K}} w(t) & K < 0 \end{cases}, \text{ initial } \begin{cases} J(0) = 0 \\ J'(0) = w(0) \end{cases} \quad (3)$$

① $K > 0, K=1, S^2$

$$J(t) = \sin t \cdot w(t)$$

$$J(0) = J(\pi) = 0$$

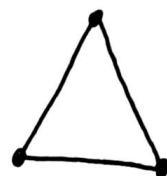
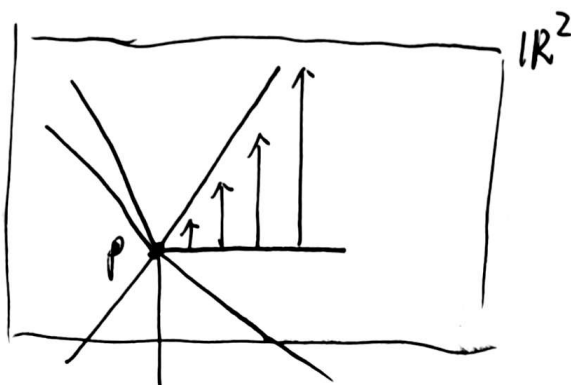


② $K=0, \mathbb{R}^2$

$$J(t) = t \cdot w(t)$$

$$J(0) = 0, |J'(0)| = 1$$

$$J(t) > 0, t > 0$$

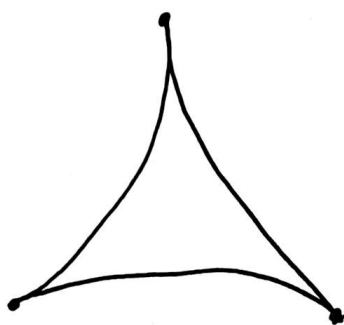


③ $K < 0, K=-1, H^2$

$$J(t) = \sinh t \cdot w(t)$$

$$J(0) = 0$$

$$J(t), t > 0$$



④

Proof.

Let $\gamma: [0, a] \rightarrow M$ be a geodesic, J be a Jacobi field along γ with $J(0) = 0$, $\frac{DJ}{dt}(0) = w$, $\gamma'(0) = v$. Consider w as an element of $T_{\gamma(0)}(T_{\gamma(0)}M)$.

Construct a curve $w(s)$ in $T_{\gamma(0)}M$ with $w(0) = av$, $w'(0) = w$.

Put $f(t, s) = \exp_p(\frac{t}{a}v(s))$, $p = \gamma(0)$. Define a Jacobi field $\bar{J}(t) = \frac{\partial f}{\partial s}(t, 0)$.

Claim: $\bar{J} = J$ on $[0, a]$.

Proof:

For $s=0$, we have

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{D}{dt} \frac{\partial f}{\partial s} &= \frac{D}{dt} ((d\exp_p)_{tv}(tw)) = \frac{D}{dt} (t(d\exp_p)_{tv}(w)) \\ &= (d\exp_p)_{tv}(w) + t \frac{D}{dt} ((d\exp_p)_{tv}(w)) \end{aligned}$$

$$\xrightarrow{t=0} \frac{D\bar{J}}{dt}(0) = \frac{D}{dt} \frac{\partial f}{\partial s}(0, 0) = (d\exp_p)_0(w) = w.$$

$$\Rightarrow \begin{cases} J(0) = \bar{J}(0) \\ \frac{DJ}{dt}(0) = \frac{D\bar{J}}{dt}(0) = w \end{cases}$$

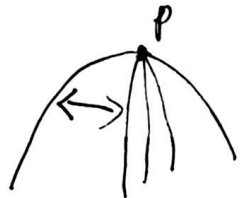
$$\Rightarrow J = \bar{J}.$$

(5) $\square$

Then, we can know

$$J(t) = (d\exp_p)_{\gamma'(0)}(tJ'(0)), t \in [0, a], v = \gamma'(0), w = J'(0), J(0) = 0.$$

Next, we consider the speed of spread apart.



Proof.

$p \in M$, $\gamma: [0, a] \rightarrow M$ is a geodesic with $\gamma(0) = p$, $\gamma'(0) = v$. Let $w \in T_v(T_p M)$

with $|w| = 1$ and J be Jacobi field along γ ,

$$J(t) = (d\exp_p)_{tv}(tw), 0 \leq t \leq a.$$

$$\text{Claim: } |J(t)|^2 = t^2 - \frac{1}{3} \langle R(v, w)v, w \rangle t^4 + O(t^4).$$

Proof:

$$\langle J, J \rangle(w) = 0 \quad 0 \cdot t^0$$

$$\langle J, J' \rangle(w) = 2 \langle J, J' \rangle(w) = 0 \quad 0 \cdot t$$

$$\langle J, J'' \rangle(w) = 2 \langle J', J' \rangle(w) + 2 \langle J'', J \rangle(w) = 2 \times 1 = 2 \quad 1 \cdot t^2$$

$$\text{As } J''(0) = -R(\gamma', J) \gamma'(0) = 0,$$

$$\langle J, J \rangle'''(w) = 6 \langle J', J'' \rangle(w) + 2 \langle J'', J \rangle(w) = 0 \quad 0 \cdot t^3$$

Then, we compute $\langle J, J \rangle''''(w)$. We know

$$\frac{D}{dt} (R(\gamma', J) \gamma') (w) = R(\gamma', J') \gamma'(w)$$

Take any vector field w .

$$\frac{d}{dt} \langle R(\gamma', J) \gamma', w \rangle = \left\langle \frac{D}{dt} (R(\gamma', J) \gamma'), w \right\rangle + \langle R(\gamma', J) \gamma', w' \rangle$$

$$\frac{d}{dt} \langle R(\gamma', w) \gamma', J \rangle = \underbrace{\left\langle \frac{D}{dt} (R(\gamma', w) \gamma'), J \right\rangle}_{=0 \text{ when } t=0} + \langle R(\gamma', w) \gamma', J' \rangle - \underbrace{\langle R(\gamma', w') \gamma', J \rangle}_{=0}$$

$$\Rightarrow \left\langle \frac{D}{dt} (R(\gamma', J) \gamma'), w \right\rangle = \langle R(\gamma', J') \gamma', w \rangle$$

$$\Rightarrow J'''(0) = -R(\gamma', J') \gamma'(0)$$

Then,

$$\langle J, J \rangle''''(w) = 8 \langle J', J''' \rangle(w) + 6 \langle J'', J'' \rangle(w) + 2 \langle J''', J \rangle(w)$$

$$= -8 \langle J', R(\gamma', J') \gamma' \rangle(w)$$

$$= -8 \langle R(w, w) w, w \rangle \rightarrow -\frac{1}{3} \langle R(w, w) w, w \rangle \cdot t^4$$

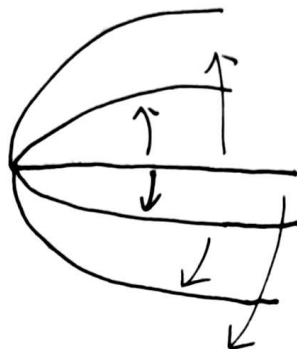
So

$$|J(t)|^2 = t^2 - \frac{1}{3} \langle R(w, w)w, w \rangle t^4 + o(t^4).$$

□

Let p be the initial point of γ and $\sigma = \text{span}\{w, w\} \subset T_p M$. For the sectional curvature K , we have

$$\begin{aligned} |J(t)|^2 &= t^2 - \frac{1}{3} K(p, \sigma) t^4 + o(t^4) \\ &= t^2 (1 - \frac{1}{3} K(p, \sigma) t^2 + o(t^2)) \end{aligned}$$



$$\begin{aligned} \Rightarrow |J(t)| &= t (1 - \frac{1}{6} K(p, \sigma) t^2 + o(t^2)) \quad (\sqrt{1+\epsilon} = 1 + \frac{1}{2}\epsilon - \frac{1}{8}\epsilon^2 + \dots) \\ &= t - \frac{1}{6} K(p, \sigma) t^3 + o(t^3) \end{aligned}$$

Example:

$$\mathbb{R}^n \quad ① \begin{cases} |J(0)| = 1 \\ |J'(0)| = 0 \end{cases}$$

$$② \begin{cases} |J(0)| = 0 \\ |J'(0)| = 1 \end{cases}$$

(7)

$$\frac{D^2 J}{dt^2} = 0$$

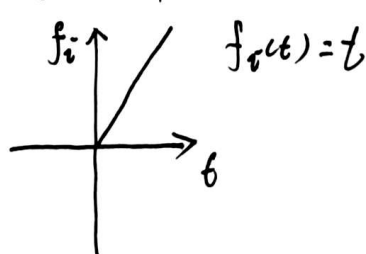
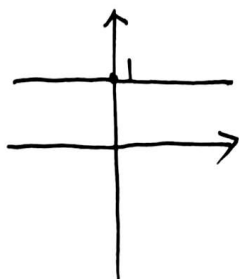
$$e_1(t), \dots, e_n(t)$$

$$J(t) = \sum_i f_i(t) e_i(t)$$

$$f_i''(t) e_i(t) = 0$$

$$① \begin{cases} f_i(0) = 1 \\ f_i'(0) = 0 \end{cases}$$

$$② \begin{cases} f_i(0) = 0 \\ f_i'(0) = 1 \end{cases}$$



Def (Conjugate point)

$\gamma: [0, a] \rightarrow M$ be a geodesic. The point $\gamma(t_0)$ is said to be conjugate to $\gamma(0)$ along γ , $t_0 \in [0, a]$, if

$\exists$ a Jacobi field along γ , J , s.t.

$$J(0) = J(t_0) = 0$$

The maximal number of linearly independent fields is called multiplicity of the conjugate point $\gamma(t_0)$.

For $\dim M = n$, $\exists$ n linearly independent Jacobi fields along the $\gamma: [0, a] \rightarrow M$, $J(0) = 0$. The Jacobi fields $J_1, \dots, J_k$, $J_i(0) = 0$ are linearly independent iff $J_1'(0), \dots, J_k'(0)$ are linearly independent.

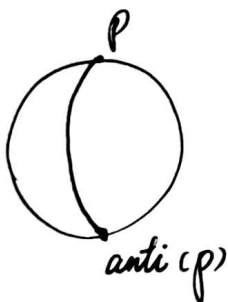
$$J(t) = t \gamma'(s) \neq 0, \text{ for } t \neq 0. \quad \boxed{n-1}$$

$$\text{multiplicity} \leq n-1$$

Example:

(8)

$$S^n, K=1. J(t) = \sin t \cdot v(t). J(0) = J(\pi) = 0.$$



$$\text{multiplicity} = n-1$$

$$C(p) = -p.$$

Def:

The set of conjugate points to the point $p \in M$, for all geodesic that start at p , is called the conjugate locus of p and is denoted by C_p .

Prop:

$\gamma: [0, a] \rightarrow M$ is a geodesic and $\gamma(a) = p$. $q = \gamma(b_0)$, $t_0 \in [0, a]$ is conjugate to p along γ iff $v_0 = t_0 \gamma'(0)$ is a critical point of $\exp_p$.

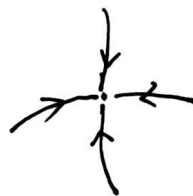
critical point:

$$\exp_p: T_p M \rightarrow M$$

$$(d \exp_p)_v: T_v(T_p M) \rightarrow T_{\exp_p(v)} M \text{ (not surjective)}$$

$$\exists w \in T_p M, w \neq 0, \text{ s.t.}$$

$$d(\exp_p)_v(w) = 0$$



Multiplicity of q is equal to the dim of kernel of the linear map $(d \exp_p)_{v_0}$.

$$\text{multi } q = \dim \ker (d \exp_p)_{t_0 v}$$

(9)